

There is no exact science to understand the history and evolution of any given industry. Everything boils down to understanding the origins of the industry and how big companies have scaled up, and why others have failed in the industry. This requires intense reading of how various companies started and their strategies over the years.

This is a broad, but not exhaustive, list of questions that should be asked to understand industry history and evolution.



When was the need for the product first felt?



What were the gains that the customers were trying to receive or the pains they were trying to relieve?



Which was the first company started in the industry?



How and when did the other companies start?



Which are the companies that have gone on to become industry leaders?



How were they established?



When were they established?



What strategies did they use for growing and scaling up their business?



Which are the companies that started but have failed?



Why did they fail?



What strategies were they using for growth and scale-up?



How has the need changed over time?



How has the product changed over time?